SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #105 · GOD'S WILL & GUIDANCE

"If something is hard, it can't be God's will."

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Where it often comes from

Teaching that God's will always feels peaceful and easy. Using "closed doors" as the only sign of God's leading. Wanting to avoid pain or conflict. Discouragement when following God led into difficulty. A culture that values comfort.

What Scripture teaches

God's will often includes hard things. The apostles taught that we must endure many hardships to enter the kingdom of God. Jesus prayed in Gethsemane, "Not My will, but Yours be done," and God's will led Him to the cross. Scripture says suffering produces perseverance, character, and hope. Ease is not proof of God's will, and difficulty is not proof that you are outside it. We fix our eyes on Jesus, who endured the cross for the joy set before Him.

> *"'Father, if You are willing, take this cup from Me. Yet not My will, but Yours be done.'"*
> **(Luke 22:42)**.

Also see

> "Strengthening the souls of the disciples and encouraging them to continue in the faith. 'We must endure many hardships to enter the kingdom of God,' they said" **(Acts 14:22)**.

> "Not only that, but we also rejoice in our sufferings, because we know that suffering produces perseverance; perseverance, character; and character, hope" **(Romans 5:3–4)**.

> "Therefore, since we are surrounded by such a great cloud of witnesses, let us throw off every encumbrance and the sin that so easily entangles, and let us run with endurance the race set out for us. Let us fix our eyes on Jesus, the author and perfecter of our faith, who for the joy set before Him endured the cross, scorning its shame, and sat down at the right hand of the throne of God" **(Hebrews 12:1–2)**.

> "We are hard pressed on all sides, but not crushed; perplexed, but not in despair; persecuted, but not forsaken; struck down, but not destroyed" **(2 Corinthians 4:8–9)**.

Common self-statements

- If it's this hard, God must not be in it.
- God's will should feel easy.
- Difficulty means I took a wrong turn.
- I should quit because it's hard.
- A closed door always means no.
- If I were in God's will, everything would go smoothly.

Common logical errors

- **Emotional reasoning:** Deciding God's will by how easy or hard something feels.
- **Overgeneralization:** Treating every difficulty as a sign from God.
- **Avoidance:** Using "it's hard" as a reason to quit what God has called you to.

- **Mental filter:** Overlooking how often God's people faced hardship in His will.

Challenging questions

- Was the cross easy for Jesus? Was it God's will?
- What did the apostles say about hardships?
- What does suffering produce, according to Romans 5:3–4?
- Is ease always a sign of God's will?
- Am I quitting because God is leading me away or because it is hard?
- What wise counsel do I need about this situation?
- How can I fix my eyes on Jesus in this difficulty?

Truth summary

> Something being hard does not mean it isn't God's will. God's will led Jesus to the cross, and His people often face hardships. Suffering can produce perseverance, character, and hope. I can seek wisdom about my situation and, when God is calling me to stay, fix my eyes on Jesus and endure.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Will of God
- Hardship
- Suffering
- Strength
- Faith

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Suffering
- Trouble/Hardship
- Weak/Tired

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If something is hard, it can't be God's will"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If something is hard, it can't be God's will." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Was the cross easy? Was it God's will?
- ☐ What did the apostles say about hardships?
- ☐ What does suffering produce?
- ☐ Is ease always a sign of God's will?
- ☐ Am I quitting because of God or because it's hard?
- ☐ How can I fix my eyes on Jesus?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Hard things can be part of God's will.
- ☐ Jesus prayed, "Not My will, but Yours be done."
- ☐ Suffering can produce perseverance, character, and hope.
- ☐ I can fix my eyes on Jesus and endure.
- ☐ Difficulty is not proof that I am outside God's will.
- ☐ I am hard pressed but not crushed.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Luke 22:42**
  "'Father, if You are willing, take this cup from Me. Yet not My will, but Yours be done.'"
- [ ] **Acts 14:22**
  "Strengthening the souls of the disciples and encouraging them to continue in the faith. 'We must endure many hardships to enter the kingdom of God,' they said."
- [ ] **Romans 5:3–4**
  "Not only that, but we also rejoice in our sufferings, because we know that suffering produces perseverance; perseverance, character; and character, hope."
- [ ] **Hebrews 12:1–2**
  "Therefore, since we are surrounded by such a great cloud of witnesses, let us throw off every encumbrance and the sin that so easily entangles, and let us run with endurance the race set out for us. Let us fix our eyes on Jesus, the author and perfecter of our faith, who for the joy set before Him endured the cross, scorning its shame, and sat down at the right hand of the throne of God."
- [ ] **2 Corinthians 4:8–9**
  "We are hard pressed on all sides, but not crushed; perplexed, but not in despair; persecuted, but not forsaken; struck down, but not destroyed."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Endurance log:** Each day, write one hard thing I faced and one way God helped me endure it.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Romans 5:3–4 becomes: "**Sarah** can rejoice in **her** sufferings, because **she** knows that suffering produces perseverance; perseverance, character; and character, hope."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Hardship" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read Luke 22:39–46,** and write how Jesus prayed in His hardest moment.
- ☐ **Write down a hard situation you are in,** and ask: "Is God calling me to leave, or to endure?" Seek counsel.
- ☐ **List people in Scripture who did God's will through hardship,** such as Joseph, Daniel, and Paul.
- ☐ **Take one small faithful step** in the hard thing God has given you this week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If something is hard, it can't be God's will": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One way God helped me endure
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If something is hard, it can't be God's will.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that Jesus was willing to do Your will even when it was hard. Help me reject the lie that if something is hard, it can't be Your will. Give me wisdom to know when to stay and strength to endure, with my eyes fixed on Jesus. Not my will, but Yours be done. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.